

10 Days, 10 Actions, 10x Unstuck

2nd Edition — Full Manuscript Preview

A 10-DAY WORKBOOK

10 days. 10 actions.
10x unstuck.

A 10-Day Guide to Getting Unstuck.

TAMARA MEDINA

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*"If today were the last day of your life,
how would you live?"*

- Steve Jobs

What would you do differently if you knew today was the day everything changed? Maybe you're staring down a career that no longer fits. Maybe the kids just left and the house is quiet in a way you didn't expect. Maybe a divorce, a move, or a retirement has handed you a blank page you didn't ask for. Whatever brought you here, one thing is true: you picked up this guide at this exact moment for a reason.

Change doesn't require a dramatic leap. It requires a little every day, repeated until it becomes permanent. The small actions you take this week will quietly become the habits that carry you through the next chapter of your life.

about me



I've spent over fifteen years coaching people through exactly this kind of turning point, helping them turn a half-formed idea into a real business, a vague goal into a plan, and hesitation into action. My clients have built companies across Mexico, the United States, and England.

"Starting over isn't a sign something went wrong. It's often the moment things start going right."

I know that step personally. I left my home country and started over in a place where I knew almost no one. I changed careers more than once, each time from scratch — and it gets easier with practice.

Tamara Medina

how we'll work together

- 1 One day, one action.** Each chapter gives you a single, focused exercise — one honest, concrete thing, then build on it tomorrow.
- 2 This is a workbook, not a lecture.** The real work happens in your own answers — write things down honestly, even the unfinished parts.
- 3 Expect twenty to thirty minutes a day.** Built in small, repeatable pieces instead of one overwhelming plan.
- 4 I'm walking through this with you, not ahead of you.** Real moments from my path and my clients', including where they got stuck.
- 5 Ten days, ten actions, ten times the momentum.** A small but real track record of showing up for yourself, one day at a time.

before day one

KEY TAKEAWAY

Big change rarely comes from one big decision. It comes from small, repeated actions that eventually become who you are.

PRO TIP

Set a specific time of day for your twenty minutes before Day One. A fixed time turns "I'll get to it" into a habit you actually keep.

REAL TRANSFORMATION

"Taking care of myself is the best investment for my life... it took a lot of tears and loneliness to realize where I had to begin. One of the most important tools was these ten actions."

— Marisol, Spain

Actionable Workbook

1. **Name your starting point.** Two or three sentences on where you are right now, without judging it.
2. **Identify your blank page.** Name the transition that brought you to this guide, plainly.
3. **Make your commitment concrete.** Choose your specific twenty-minute time for the next ten days.
4. **Finish the sentence:** "If today were day one of the rest of my life, the one thing I'd stop putting off is _____."

1

DAY O N E



Define Success on your
own terms

Focus On opportunities,
not limits



The Secret of Success

What Does Success Even Mean to You?

The question I get asked most often — whether I'm coaching a woman leaving a twenty-year corporate career, rebuilding her confidence after a divorce, or starting over in a new country — is the same one: what does it actually take to be successful?

Before you can answer that, you have to answer a harder question: what does success even mean to *you*?

For some women, success is financial independence after years of relying on someone else's paycheck. For others, it's building a business from a kitchen table, mentoring the next generation, or simply feeling proud of who they see in the mirror.

Step 1: Define Success on Your Own Terms

Write it down. Not the version you think you're supposed to want — the one that's actually true for you right now, at this stage of your life.

"Attitude is the key."

Step 2: Focus on Opportunities, Not Limitations

When someone starts a new chapter, their first instinct is often to list every reason it might fail. That list is rarely about the plan — it's fear and self-doubt wearing the costume of "being realistic."

Think about what you've already navigated: raising children, an aging parent, a move, a divorce, a career held together through a layoff. Every one builds real, transferable skills

PRO TIP

Next time you think "I can't do this," ask: "What evidence do I actually have for this?" Most self-doubt collapses the moment you ask it to show its work.

Once you're aware of your own strengths, it becomes much easier to spot real opportunities — instead of staring at the gaps.

Step 3: Trust Yourself — Silence the Doubt

Most people already have the talent, skill, and resources to achieve what they're after. It's the inner fear that stops them — not a lack of ability. Confidence isn't a personality trait you're born with — it's a muscle you build. It grows through practice:

showing up, taking the small action anyway, and reflecting on what you learned.

If you're not yet convinced your own idea will work, no amount of polish will convince anyone else either. That conviction has to start on the inside.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Confidence isn't just a nice-to-have — it's a vital ingredient for success. It means choosing to believe in yourself and your vision, even when the path isn't clear.

REAL TRANSFORMATION — PAULA, CHILE

"With this exercise I had the opportunity to be aware that I can overcome my fears. It is not bad to be conscious about what scares me — it will give me the tools to have the strength to face them."

Your Strength Inventory

List everything you're already doing well that will help you reach the goal you're aiming for.

Use these prompts to get started

- What are you doing right, right now?
- What good habits do you already have around your goals?
- What have you specifically done so far to move toward this goal?
- What resources — time, money, relationships, skills — do you already have?

Your Definition of Success

One to two sentences: what does success mean to me, at this stage of my life? Be specific — "financial freedom" or "happiness" are starting points, not finish lines.

action 1

Today's Action

1. **Your Turning-Point Reflection.** What are the three most satisfying things you've achieved so far? What's the biggest challenge you've faced, and what did it teach you about your own strength?
2. **What do you like about yourself** — not your achievements, you?
3. **Write down one action today** that's directly linked to your definition of success, and when you're going to do it.

**Reinvention isn't built in one leap — it's built in the next small action.
Do not postpone it.**

2

DAY T W O



Separate Life values from
work values



Notice The gap between value
and reality



What Moves You?

Values Are Your Decision-Making Tool, Not a Personality Quiz

Your values are the things you don't actually question — they're the filter every decision runs through, whether you're aware of it or not. When a job, a relationship, or a whole life stage feels off in a way you can't quite name, it's rarely bad luck. It's usually a values mismatch.

Values aren't fixed at birth. They're shaped by everything you've lived through — your family, your culture, the jobs you've had, the places you've called home. Which means they can also shift as you do.

"If you want to know someone, don't ask what they think — ask what they love."

— Saint Augustine

Step 1: Separate What You Value in Life from What You Value in Work

Most people can rattle off values in the abstract — freedom, family, security — but few have actually ranked them, and fewer still have checked whether their life-values list matches their work-values list.

PRO TIP

If a value shows up on both lists but in a different position, pay attention. That's often where the friction lives.

Write both lists. Then rank each one, most important first. The ranking matters more than the list itself — two people can share the exact same five values and make completely different decisions because they order them differently.

STEP 2 · A READER'S STORY

A client — call her Claudia — landed what looked like a dream role. The interview had leaned heavily on the company's stated values, and she'd felt an immediate pull toward them. Then a new manager arrived whose style ran on humiliation. Three months in, Claudia was stressed and disillusioned, and couldn't articulate exactly why.

When we mapped her values against what was actually happening day to day, the answer was immediate: the company's stated values and her own matched almost perfectly on paper. What she was actually living through matched none of them.

KEY TAKEAWAY

A values gap isn't always a sign you chose wrong. Sometimes it's a sign that what was promised and what's actually happening have quietly stopped being the same thing. That's information you can act on.

REAL TRANSFORMATION — SUNNY, LONDON

"I never really thought about my values — you kind of think you know. This exercise made me think about what is really important. It gave me insight into past situations and made me realize how important it is to think about my values when setting goals."

Your Two Values Lists

Write two lists, then rank each in order of importance. Notice any value that appears on both — and where it lands differently.

exercises

Life

Work / Business

What do you notice?

**What happens when
reality doesn't match
your values?**

action 2

Choose Your Move

1. **Spot the mismatch.** Look honestly at your current situation – a job, a relationship, a routine, even a city. Where does reality line up with your ranked values, and where doesn't it?
2. **For the biggest mismatch:** renegotiate, hold the line on purpose, or exit? If holding the line, what has to be true before that changes?
3. **Past Investment Audit.** Think of one time you invested real energy in something that didn't match your values. Knowing what you know now, would you choose the same?
4. **Write down one action this week** that moves you toward your choice.

The goal isn't to escape every values gap immediately. It's to stop being unconsciously stuck in one.

3

DAY THREE



Envision Be, do, have —
three years out

Commit A dream with a
specific date

70%

80%

90%

100%

How to Turn Your Dreams into Reality

"We build our future with the actions and choices we make today. We decide what type of future we want to have."

Most of Us Plan a Holiday Better Than We Plan Our Lives

Think about the last time you planned a trip — the research, the comparing, the excitement. Now ask

yourself: when was the last time you gave that same energy to planning the rest of your life?

If you're in the middle of a career pivot, an empty nest, a divorce, or simply asking "what's next?" — you're not starting from zero. You're starting from everything you've already built.

Start With What You've Already Proven

Before you look forward, look back. Most of us are quick to list what we haven't done yet and slow to credit what we already have.

KEY REFLECTION

Think of something from the last six months you're proud of. What talents did it take? Chances are those same talents transfer directly to whatever you're building next.

The skills that got you through a difficult transition, raised a family, or rebuilt a life in a new city are the same skills that will carry your next chapter.

Three Years From Now, Everything as You Hoped

- **How do I want to BE?** Confident, energized, at peace, in motion?
- **What do I want to DO?** The actual shape of your days — building, traveling, time with people who matter?
- **What do I want to HAVE?** Material (a home, income) or intangible (peace, belonging)?

IF WORDS DON'T COME EASILY

Draw it, or build a vision board — a Pinterest board, a Notes app collage, whatever you'll actually look at. If drawing still feels blocked: imagine a genie transforming three areas of your life, ask what you'd do with six months left, or list what you don't want — the opposite is often exactly what you do want.

A Goal Is What Makes the Vision Real

A dream might be: "I want more freedom and less stress." A goal gives it edges: "By [date], I have reduced my work hours to four days a week."

KEY TAKEAWAY

The difference between a dream and a goal is a specific date.

- ✓ **Positive** — stated as what you want, not what you're escaping.
- ✓ **Present tense** — "I have," "I am," written as if already happening.
- ✓ **Specific & time-bound** — measurable, and it has a date.
- ✓ **Visible & yours** — kept somewhere you'll see it, within your own control.

Share It — Carefully

Once your goal is clear, say it out loud to someone. Talking about a goal makes it more real and

creates a quiet sense of accountability. But choose who you tell — the people closest to you aren't always your biggest champions.

PRO TIP — PRIYA, SINGAPORE

"The Goal Cycle is so effective yet so simple to implement... it's like setting out on a road trip without planning and only checking the map when you feel lost. With it, I have a better picture of how to navigate to the destination I want to reach."

REAL TRANSFORMATION — ANGELA, USA

"The third day was harder than the others because I had to be realistic about my goals and take responsibility for each one... these closer goals gave a lot more direction to my life."

action 3

Pick One Goal

1. **Name one thing you're proud of** from the last six months, and the skill that made it happen.
2. **Answer in one or two sentences each:** how do I want to be, do, and have — three years from now?
3. **Pick one goal you can move on in the next five days.** Write it positive, present tense, specific, time-bound, and fully within your control.
4. **Decide who you'll tell first** — and who you'll hold off telling.

A dream without a date is just a wish.

4

DAY F O U R



Question Name the belief you
never tested

Trace The thought-to-results
cycle



What Does Your Inner Voice Say?

Why Motivation Isn't Enough

You know how to set a goal. You've probably done it a hundred times. So why do you start strong and end up back in the same routine? Ninety percent of my work as a coach is not goal-setting. It's helping someone find the belief that's quietly blocking them.

What holds us back is rarely a lack of a plan. It's a belief we've never questioned.

What a Belief Actually Is

A belief is something you accepted without ever putting it on trial. Some beliefs build you up. Others quietly convince you

"You are what you believe in. You become that which you believe you can become."

— The Bhagavad Gita

that you can't. Both feel equally true from the inside, which is exactly why they're so hard to spot.

KEY TAKEAWAY

The thought-to-results cycle is neutral. It amplifies whatever belief you feed it. Change what goes in, and the results on the other end change too.

Author Brian Mayne describes it as a cycle: an idea produces an emotion, the emotion shapes your behavior, repeated behavior becomes a habit, and the habit produces your results. Then the loop repeats.



Brian Mayne

BREAKING MY OWN BARRIER

I had a belief I never questioned: our family is not good for business. It came from my mother, who used to say people only get money in bad ways. Tracing it back, my maternal grandparents ran a successful business

— the belief had no evidence behind it at all. It was just something I'd absorbed and never once tested.

Your Belief Reset Worksheet

- 1. Where did this belief come from?**
- 2. Who gave me this belief?**
- 3. How do I feel about the person that gave me this belief?** Do I respect them?
Are/were they always right? What is their history?
- 4. What is this belief costing me on a daily basis?**
- 5. What will holding this belief mean for me in the long term?**
- 6. How will my life be different if I let go of this belief?**

quieting the inner critic

What Does Your Inner Voice Say?

Every day you have hundreds of thoughts, and you treat most of them as true just because they're loud. They aren't. They're a habit, and habits can be retrained.

Turn Down the Volume

Literally imagine a dial, until it's background noise.

Change the Tone

Until it sounds absurd instead of authoritative — a cartoon villain, not a verdict.

Name It and Set It Down

Say what it's saying out loud, then set it aside — like putting down a bag you've carried too long.

REAL TRANSFORMATION — HEATHER PARKER, COACH & PSYCHOLOGIST

"Tamara kept bringing it back to what I want: 'It's totally understandable how this limiting belief came about, but do you want it to hold you back now?' That helped me pause, identify what was holding me back, and start taking concrete action."

action 4

Name It, Track It, Turn It Off

1. **Name one belief you've never questioned.** Use the Belief Reset Worksheet to trace where it came from and what it's costing you today.
2. **Track your inner voice for one week.** Each time you catch a negative thought, jot down what it said and what triggered it.
3. **Pick your "turn it off" method** and practice it the next three times the critical voice shows up.
4. **Reflection:** if you fully let go of that belief, what would you do differently this month — not someday, this month?

The goal isn't to silence every negative thought forever. It's to stop automatically believing the first thing it says.

5

DAY FIVE



Audit Log three days,
honestly

Focus Protect
your peak hours



Time: Does It Control You or Do You Control It?

The Hours Don't Change. Your Structure Does.

Time management gets hardest at the exact moments life stops handing you a schedule. A new job gives you set hours. A marriage or a household gives you a shared rhythm. Retirement, a divorce, an empty nest, a move to a new country, or the launch of your own business all remove that built-in structure at once.

Suddenly the hours are entirely yours to fill, and that freedom can feel like more of a burden than a gift. You feel busy all day and still can't say what you actually got done. That gap, between motion and progress, is what this chapter is about.

You cannot change what you don't measure. Before you can fix how you spend your time, you need an honest, judgment-free look at where it currently goes.

"The future has many names: for the weak, it means the unattainable. For the fearful, it means the unknown. For the courageous, it means opportunity."

— Victor Hugo

What Procrastination Actually Looks Like

Procrastination rarely looks like doing nothing.

It looks like staying busy with everything except the one thing that matters

— rearranging a desk, hunting for a pen, checking email, watering the plants. Anything that feels productive without moving you an inch closer to what you set out to do.

PRO TIP

Time management isn't about working harder — it's working smart: know your peak hours, delegate before you're desperate, and set boundaries out loud.

Read that back and notice how familiar it sounds. Procrastination isn't laziness. It's your brain finding motion that feels safer than the real task.

The Time Audit — Get the Data Before You Judge Yourself

For three days, log your hours in real time, or from memory each evening. Use these four categories — add your own as you go.

Work & Responsibilities

- Job / business tasks
- Caregiving, errands
- Meetings, admin

Health & Growth

- Exercise, learning
- Spiritual practice
- Hobbies, creativity

Connection

- Family, friends
- Community, dating
- Conversations that matter

Rest

- Sleep, naps
- Genuine downtime
- Not scrolling

exercises

Time	Category	Notes
5:00 AM		
6:00 AM		
7:00 AM		
		<i>continues hourly through 4:00 AM</i>
10:00 PM		
11:00 PM		

action 5

Consider Your Priorities

1. **Run the three-day time audit.** Log your hours across Work, Health, Connection, and Rest. Don't edit as you go — just record.
2. **Total each category** and ask: what's getting more time than it deserves? What's getting less?
3. **Pick one boundary to set out loud this week** — a closing time, a day you don't answer messages, a task you hand off.
4. **Reflection:** if your time were truly under your own control tomorrow, what's the first thing you'd protect?

To change things, you need to take action.

6

DAY SIX



Ask 8–12 people who know you

Pattern What repeats across answers



Are You the Person You Want to Be?

The Gap Between How You See Yourself and How Others Do

You've just spent days getting clear on your values, your goals, and your fears.

But there's a piece missing: how does anyone else see you? Most of us assume the two match. It usually doesn't.

There are things about you that are obvious to a colleague, a friend, or your sister, that you can't see yourself, not because you're hiding them, but because none of us can watch ourselves from the outside.

"What appears is not always what it is and what it is not always what it seems; perception creates our own reality."

— Rob McBride

PRO TIP

What you believe you're hiding, everyone else can usually see anyway. That's not something to fear, it's the fastest way to find out what to work on next.

That blind spot can hold good news too. People often discover strengths they didn't know they had, not just weaknesses they'd rather not look at. Either way, the only way to close the gap is to ask.

Put together a short questionnaire and send it to 8 to 12 people who know you from different parts of your life. Give everyone a deadline, ideally before your 10 days are up. If you'd rather not have answers tied to a name, use a free tool like Google Forms or Typeform.

SEVEN STARTING QUESTIONS

1. What's the first thing that comes to mind when you think of me?
2. What do you consider the most interesting thing about me?
3. What do you think has been my greatest achievement?
4. What do you value most about me?
5. What do you think are my strengths and weaknesses?
6. What skills would I need to build for my next chapter to succeed?
7. If I were featured in a magazine article or podcast, what would the story be about?

exercises

Look for the Patterns

Once responses start coming in, don't jump straight to reflecting on yourself. Read through everything first and look for what repeats.

- Which strengths does more than one person mention?
- Which weaknesses show up more than once, even phrased differently?
- What surprised you, something you didn't think anyone noticed?

action 6

Decide Who You're Becoming

1. **Build your list.** Name 8 to 12 people from different parts of your life to send your questionnaire to. Set a deadline before the end of your 10 days.
2. **Send it,** named or anonymous, then wait for responses.
3. **Find the pattern.** Write down the strengths and growth areas that came up more than once.
4. **Set your direction.** Pick one person you admire, one quality of theirs you want to build, and a single specific goal you can act on this week.

Once you're clear on how you want to be and how others see you, it's much easier to define what to work on.



DAY SE V E N



Notice When you're on
autopilot

Choose Sometimes you lose
to win



Where Are My Daily Decisions Taking Me?

"All life is an experiment. The more experiments you make the better."

— Ralph Waldo Emerson

When I first moved to London, I saw the city like a tourist. Everything felt new: the pace, the crowds, even the sea of black coats every winter. On the underground, I watched people head home after work looking drained and far away, like their minds were somewhere else entirely.

Six months later, I caught my own reflection in a train window. Same black coat. Same tired, faraway look. Somewhere in the process of fitting into my new life, I had stopped noticing myself.

This is what autopilot living does. It doesn't happen all at once. It happens one unnoticed day at a time, until you look up and don't recognize who's looking back.

A READER'S STORY

One of my clients ran the design department at a well-known university. She loved the work, but the role had swallowed her life — 12 to 14 hour days, most weekends, no time for the relationship she quietly wanted. She stepped back to two or three classes a week. "How can you leave something so secure?" her closest friends asked. For the first time, she felt like she was actually driving her own life.

KEY TAKEAWAY

There is no change without loss. But looking back with the perspective of time, what I've gained has always outweighed what I lost.

Direction Check*Where Are My Daily Decisions Taking Me?*

1. What's genuinely important to you right now, and what are you actually doing about it?
2. Are today's decisions steering you toward the life you want, or are circumstances making the choices for you?
3. Do you feel like a leaf in the wind, or in the driver's seat?

PRO TIP

Change one small route today, literally or figuratively. A different street, a different order of tasks, a different way of answering "how are you." Small interruptions to autopilot are how you find out whether you're driving or just riding.

action 7

Change the Route

1. **What are you ready to let go of?** A job, a routine, an old version of yourself, that's no longer serving you.
2. **Change the route.** Do one thing differently today — a new path home, music instead of scrolling, a conversation you'd normally skip.
3. **Write down what you noticed** and how it felt.
4. **The five-year letter.** By hand, write the person you love most a letter dated five years from today, describing your life if nothing changes from here.

Seeing the cost of staying on autopilot in your own handwriting is often what turns "I should probably change something" into "I'm changing this now."

8

DAY E I G H T



Audit Who leaves you steadier or smaller

Hotel Not everyone earns a permanent room



Choose Your Influences More Wisely

When Your Circle Changes Without Asking

Early in my career, I became close with a colleague named Jimena. She was magnetic, funny, and endlessly talented. She wanted to write books, and her storytelling made the whole room lean in. Years later, I could see the friendship more clearly from a distance. Every conversation still circled the same spot: her unfinished dream, the same doubts, the same excuses.

Eventually I let the friendship go. I told her plainly: "In ten years, I don't want to still be hearing about the books you're

"The values of the world we inhabit and the people we surround ourselves with have a profound effect on who we are."

— **Malcolm Gladwell, Outliers**

going to write. I want to hear about the ones you published." That was five years ago. I'm still waiting.

PRO TIP

The tell isn't one bad conversation. It's the pattern. One skeptical comment from someone who loves you is feedback. The same deflating comment every time is information.

Your circle doesn't wait for your permission to change. Reinvention isn't just about changing what you do. It's about deciding, on purpose, who comes with you.

Your Heart Is a Hotel, Not a Storage Unit

Think of your heart as a hotel. Some people check in for a season and check out, and that's fine. A few earn a permanent room. Nobody gets in for free, and nobody has to stay just because they've been there a long time.

The mistake most of us make is treating our heart like a storage unit instead of a hotel: once someone's in, they stay, no matter how long it's been since they added anything.

Two Kinds of People, and How to Tell Them Apart

Some people leave you steadier than they found you. They ask real questions, celebrate your wins without competing with

them, and tell you the truth even when it's not what you want to hear.

Others leave you smaller. They deflate your plans before you've finished the sentence, and being around them costs you energy you don't get back.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Choose your circle based on who aligns with your values, not on convenience. Some are strategic allies who challenge your ideas. Others champion you in rooms you're not even in.

When the Draining Person Is Family

Distance is the easy answer when the draining person is a casual friend. It's harder when it's your mother, your ex, your grown child, or a partner. You can't always exit those rooms, but you can change what you bring into them.

Share less detail with people who reliably use it against you. Save the vulnerable, half-formed version of your plan for the one or two people who've earned it.

Be Someone Worth Having in the Room

Auditing your circle only works if you also turn the question on yourself. Think back to a moment when someone made you feel completely seen. Those moments weren't accidents.

Someone chose to be fully there instead of thinking about their next task.

KEY TAKEAWAY — MAYA ANGELOU

"People forget what you said, people forget what you did, but people will never forget how you made them feel."

exercises

Run the Hotel Audit

Steadier. List three people who consistently leave you steadier. For each, one sentence on what

they specifically do.

Smaller. List three who consistently leave you smaller. Same — one sentence each on the specific pattern, not just the feeling.

action 8

Name the Room, Then Say It Out Loud

1. **Pick one relationship to change on purpose.** Name one specific thing you'll do differently next time you talk to the most draining name on your list.
2. **Name your permanent-room people.** Who has actually earned the room? When did you last tell them?
- 3.
4. **This week's action.** Do one specific, generous thing for someone in your permanent room, and tell them directly what they mean to you – not "you're great," but exactly what they've done.

Today, do something special for someone. Talk to someone and tell them what they mean to you.

9

DAY N I N E



Weather Storms pass if you
keep driving

Own Your reactions are yours to
choose



Taking Responsibility and Decision Making

In the Middle of the Storm

A couple of years ago, I was driving when torrential rain broke without warning. I couldn't see the road. My first instinct was to stop and give up, but stopping felt more dangerous than pushing through. Thirty minutes later, the rain cleared, the sun came out, and there was a rainbow.

Now, whenever I'm in the middle of a hard stretch, I go back to that moment. If I stay focused, I know I'll get to the other side.

"It's not what happens that makes the biggest difference. It's how you respond that makes the biggest difference."

— Brian Mayne

PRO TIP

Don't forget that you control how you feel. We often give too much power to the circumstances and people around us. Take control of your emotions and decide how you want to feel.

Reinvention comes with its own storms: a divorce, a layoff, a move to a new city. None of that is a sign you took a wrong turn. It's just weather. It passes if you keep driving.

Own Your Reactions

You are the only person who can change your life and your relationships. We can't control what happens around us, but we can control ourselves, and that's the only lever that actually moves anything.

Having a positive attitude doesn't mean smiling through everything. It means being proactive instead of reactive.

1. Name the feeling. Say a former colleague gets the promotion you were quietly hoping would open a door for you. Instead of stewing, name it: "This brings up disappointment and a little envy." Naming it takes away some of its grip.

2. Choose your next hour, not your whole day. "That email ruined my day" is a story you're telling, not a fact. Did that situation make you feel something, or did you hand it the authority to decide how you feel?

TAKE RESPONSIBILITY

As Scott Peck wrote in *The Road Less Traveled*: "Life is a series of problems. Do we complain about them or solve them?" Blame is easy and it keeps you exactly where you are. Next time you're stuck, ask yourself:

1. What is my contribution to the situation as it stands right now?
2. What am I getting out of staying stuck?
3. What can I actually do to change it?

REAL TRANSFORMATION — RENATA, BRAZIL

"It is difficult to take responsibility and decisions at the same time, but when you do that you can understand yourself better... It gives you the power of finding happiness where you have never looked before: yourself."

How You Make Decisions

A**nalYTical** — weighing scenarios, running the pros and cons. Useful, until some people spend so long calculating

what could go wrong that they never decide anything.

Action-oriented — following instinct, moving fast. Useful too, until it's easy to get hurt by decisions made too quickly.

The goal isn't to become the other type, it's to notice which one you lean on and deliberately borrow a little from the other before a big decision.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Control the instinct to react immediately. Give yourself time to think through a situation from more than one angle, then build an action plan.

action 9

Build Your Reset List

1. **Write down 15 things you enjoy** that cost little or nothing. Keep the list visible. Next time a hard emotion shows up, pick one instead of sitting with it.
2. **Block one hour this week** as a standing date with yourself, no agenda beyond feeling like you again.
3. **Run the two-question check** on a situation you're frustrated by right now.
4. **Get decision clarity.** Split a page in two, list pros and cons on a decision you're sitting on.

Remember, your happiness is your responsibility. Today: choose one thing from your list and do it.

10

DAY T E
N



Whole A complete orange,
not a half

Grow Do the uncomfortable
thing anyway



Take Care of Yourself

Your Priority Should Be You

Somewhere along the way, many women learn to put themselves last. You keep deferring yourself, and the deferral quietly compounds. The problem with deferring is that it doesn't pause your life, it spends it.

Taking care of yourself isn't a reward you earn after everyone else is taken care of. It's the thing that makes you capable of showing up for anyone else at all. **If you don't take care of yourself, nobody else will.**

"You must be the change you wish to see in the world."

— Gandhi

REAL TRANSFORMATION — LETICIA, MEXICO

"Taking care of myself is the best investment for my life... It took a lot of tears and loneliness to realize where I had to begin. One of the most important tools was these 10 actions."

Finding a "Complete Orange," Not a "Half Orange"

There's an old idea that you need to find your "half orange," the other half

that makes you whole. It's romantic, but it sets up a trap: it suggests you're incomplete on your own.

The better model is two complete oranges choosing to roll through life side by side. Each person keeps their own friendships, interests, and goals. Neither needs the other to feel whole, but both choose the relationship because it makes an already-full life richer.

PRO TIP

Once a month, ask yourself: "What's something that's just mine right now, not shared with a partner, kids, or work?" If you can't answer quickly, that's a signal worth paying attention to.

If you're single, divorced, or rebuilding after a loss, the same question applies: are you living as a complete person right now, or waiting for someone else to complete you first?

Keep Growing, Even When It's Uncomfortable

Confidence isn't something you either have or don't. It's built, one uncomfortable step at a time. Public speaking used to scare me most. Years later, I signed up for an improvisational theater class with a room full of strangers. My name was drawn first. I stood on stage with a scene partner I'd never met, improvising for two minutes that felt like an

eternity. I got through it. The fear didn't vanish before I walked on stage, it disappeared once I was already standing there, doing the thing.

KEY TAKEAWAY

Building confidence is a journey, not a quick fix. It requires patience, practice, and sometimes a little courage to ask for help.

learn to ask for help

This was true for one of my clients, Joana. Everyone around her would describe her the same way: loving, reliable, the person you call when you need help. But when it came to asking for help herself, something stopped her every time.

Pride surfaced fast. Joana believed the people around her saw her as strong and self-sufficient. So I asked her how she felt when other people asked *her* for help. She lit up. "I love it," she said. "It means they trust me. It's an honor." I asked her why she'd deny anyone else that same feeling. She sat with that for a moment, and I watched it land.

To get support from others is a challenge for many people. If this is the case for you, remember that by doing so you give others the opportunity to feel special.

PRO TIP

When you ask for help, try to be as specific as possible. That gives the other person a real chance to think about what exactly you require of them, how long it will take, and whether they can do it.

THE SPECIFIC ASK

Vague: "Can you help me with my business plan?"

Specific: "Could you look over the marketing section and

suggest two or three ways I could promote my services online?"

action 10

Name Your Ten

1. **Build your Positivity Wall.** Start a running collection of post-it notes somewhere visible — phrases, reminders, quotes that pull you back to center.
2. **Name your ten.** List ten things you've always wanted to do but haven't. Don't filter them.
3. **Pick one and set a date.** Choose one thing you'll do this week, write the exact day, and one sentence on how you think you'll feel.
4. **Practice one specific ask.** Rewrite a vague request as a specific one and send it to someone this week.

A date and a feeling turn a wish into a plan.

Conclusion



Clarity

You know what you want, and why



Action

You know how to turn a goal into a result



Support

You know who belongs around you



conclusion

You Already Did the Hard Part

Ten days ago, starting felt like the hardest part. You did it anyway. Real change doesn't happen because you read a

guide. It happens because you did the exercises, sat with the uncomfortable questions, and kept going on the days it would have been easier to stop.

That's not a small thing. Whatever stage of reinvention brought you here, a career pivot, a divorce, an empty nest, a

retirement, a move to a new country, you've already proven you can face it head-on.

What You Now Know

Clarity. You identified your values and the beliefs driving your decisions, good and bad.

Action. You practiced setting goals and closing the gap between what you say you want and what you actually do.

Support. You looked honestly at your influences, and who belongs around you now.

What Happens Next

Here's the part the first version of this guide skipped: knowing is not the same as doing. The next thirty days will test whether these ten days actually stuck.

You don't need a perfect plan. You need one repeatable action, done on purpose, more days than not. **Every moment is a chance to start again**, even the days you fall off track.

KEY TAKEAWAY

There are no results without action. The gap between where you are and where you want to be closes one decision at a time, not one insight at a time.

PRO TIP

If it doesn't challenge you, it doesn't change you. If the next step feels easy, it's probably not the step that moves you forward.

BEFORE YOU CLOSE THIS GUIDE

- 1. Name the shift.** What's one specific thing, a belief, a habit, a decision, that's genuinely different now?
- 2. Keep one, release one.** Name a belief working in your favor and one quietly holding you back.
- 3. Pick your repeatable action.** Choose the one you'll keep doing weekly. Put it on your calendar now.
- 4. Check your circle.** Do the three people you talk to most know what you're working toward?

REAL TRANSFORMATION — INGRID, NORWAY

"Taking care of myself is the best investment for my life... It took a lot of tears and loneliness to realize where I had to begin. One of the most important tools was these 10 actions. Thank you."



*"The difference between dreaming and making your dreams come true
is to take action."*

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